A Day In NCC Camp

The 4 am whistle didn't just wake me up it jolted me into a different world. One minute I was warm in my sleeping bag, the next I was fumbling with my laces in dark tent, surrounded by dozens of fellow cadets. There is no "five more minutes" in a camp, there is only the fallin.

By 4:30 am we were standing still pt wg on the dew-covered grass. The Monday PT was brutal, but something shifts when you're running in formation. Your individual exhaustion disappears into the rhythm of your buddies. By the time sun finally showed up, I was drenched in sweat and breathing hard, but the cold was gone, replaced by a strange sense of clarity.

The rest of the day was blurs of dust and discipline. We spent hours on the drill ground, trying to ~~turn~~ sixty steps into one single sound. My thumb ached from snapping the rifle into the place, my throat was raw from shouting commands. But during the breaks, sitting in the shade and sharing a ~~tasty~~ mess tin of dal chappati and rice, the exhaustion was vanished.

After the lunch it was time for maintainence duties, assigning tasks was on me. Though few were making cuts & had to complete short, by the evening it was time for game parade, the last basket came with a josh in the cadets.

Then final roll call and the dinner. When "Lights Out" finally sounded the silence was absolute. We all were gossiping and joking a moment ago but now every one just felt into great slumber in their sleeping bag.